

About Audit Preservation Standard - (APS)

Understanding Audit Preservation Standard

What Is Audit Preservation Standard?

Audit Preservation Standard is the ninth Parent Standard of ADIT® — Continuous Audit & Evidence Governance Architecture™. It governs how audit evidence, execution records, findings, responses, decisions, approvals, and governance history are preserved throughout their complete lifecycle.

Audit Preservation Standard recognizes that an audit does not end when corrective actions are completed. The long-term value of an audit depends on whether its complete history remains preserved, accessible, trustworthy, traceable, and independently reconstructable whenever future governance, regulatory, legal, or operational review becomes necessary.

Canonical Definition

Audit Preservation Standard defines the governance conditions required to preserve audit evidence, execution records, findings, responses, decisions, approvals, and supporting governance information throughout the complete audit lifecycle. It establishes preservation methodology, lifecycle controls, retention requirements, governance mechanisms, preservation validation, and continuous preservation assurance necessary to ensure that audit history remains complete, accessible, trustworthy, traceable, and independently reconstructable over time.

Why Audit Preservation Standard Exists

Organizations frequently rely on historical audit information long after operational events have ended.

Without standardized preservation, audit records may become incomplete, inaccessible, corrupted, or impossible to reconstruct. This weakens governance, accountability, regulatory compliance, and organizational learning.

Audit Preservation Standard exists to ensure that the complete audit history remains preserved and trustworthy throughout its required lifecycle.

What

Audit Preservation Standard Governs

Audit Preservation Standard governs:

- Audit preservation
 - Audit record retention
 - Audit archives
 - Audit continuity
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- Audit history
 - Audit retrieval
 - Preservation assurance
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Use Case 1 — Autonomous AI Governance

Scenario

An organization must reconstruct the governance history of an autonomous AI system several years after an operational incident.

Application

Audit Preservation Standard governs the preservation of audit evidence, findings, corrective actions, approvals, and execution history so that the complete audit lifecycle can be reconstructed.

Result

The organization can independently verify historical governance decisions using complete, trustworthy, and preserved audit records.

Use Case 2 — Regulatory Investigation

Scenario

A regulatory authority requests historical audit records during an investigation into a critical infrastructure operator.

Application

Audit Preservation Standard governs the preservation, retrieval, validation, and governance of historical audit records throughout their retention lifecycle.

Result

Historical audit information remains complete, accessible, traceable, and independently verifiable years after the original audit was completed.

Architectural Position

Audit Preservation Standard represents the ninth governed space within ADIT® — Continuous Audit & Evidence Governance Architecture™, preserving the complete audit history before the architecture performs final audit assurance.

Governance Flow

Audit Observation → Evidence Formation → Evidence Integrity → Evidence
Correlation → Evidence Verification → Audit Execution → Audit Findings → Audit
Response → Audit Preservation → Audit Assurance

Canonical Closing Statement

Audit Preservation Standard establishes the canonical governance framework for preserving audit history throughout its complete lifecycle. By governing record retention, preservation methodology, lifecycle controls, governance validation, and continuous preservation assurance, Audit Preservation Standard enables long-term audit trust, operational reconstruction, accountable governance, and independent verification across all operational domains.

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Canonical Source

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